TrueLift

USER MANUAL

Your adaptive strength coach

Plan, adjust and log your routines to progress with sound judgement in every session.

www.truelift.es

October 2026 edition · updated 14/10/2026

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1. What TrueLift is

TrueLift is a strength training app. You train and log every set; the app decides how much weight to use in the next session, when to hold, when to deload, and shows you how you are evolving.

It works with what you log: weight, reps, RIR (reps in reserve) and, if you turn them on, your daily readiness, your HRV, your cardio and your body weight. The more complete and honest the log, the better the decisions.

This manual describes the app screen by screen. You do not need to read it all: use it as a reference whenever you have a question.

Important: TrueLift is a training support tool, not a substitute for medical advice. If you have pain or health concerns, consult a professional.

2. Free version and PRO version

The free version includes the preset routine, session logging, automatic progression, volume, progress and backups. Advanced features are part of the PRO version.

What each version includes

Feature	Free	PRO
Log sessions and automatic progression	✓	✓
Cardio, plate calculator and warm-up sets (also inside the set itself), with each machine's fixed weight	✓	✓
Rest timer with alarm and minute beeps, floating timer (Android) and Live Activity (iPhone)	✓	✓
Weekly volume and frequency, microcycle length and real-volume history	✓	✓
Progress: charts, personal records, strength level by exercise and by muscle group, and overall assessment	✓	✓
Live alerts for records and new strength levels, with their own switch	✓	✓
Top set + back-offs	✓	✓
Mark an exercise as trained with pain or limitations	✓	✓
Body measurements and progress photos: logging, history and gallery	✓	✓
Share a session as an image, also with your own background photo	✓	✓
Backups and the Coach desktop app	✓	✓
Swap an exercise for another of the same pattern and group	✓	✓
Rename your routine	✓	✓
Export your routine to Excel	✓	✓
Language (ES / EN / PT-BR), kg / lb units and text size	✓	✓
Daily log reminder	✓	✓
Import a routine from Excel	✓	✓
Import your history from Hevy or Strong	✓	✓

Feature	Free	PRO
Technique video for the library's exercises	✓	✓
Reset an exercise's performance baseline and pinned exercise log	✓	✓
Edit the routine: sets, reps, RIR, rest, add and remove exercises, change pattern	—	✓
Rename and reorder sessions and exercises	—	✓
Create your own exercises in the library, by reps or by time	—	✓
PRO routines ready to train	—	✓
Create your routine with AI (questionnaire + prompt)	—	✓
Drop sets	—	✓
Supersets	—	✓
Rest-pause	—	✓
Autoregulation: daily check-in, readiness to train and fatigue by body region	—	✓
HRV and resting heart rate	—	✓
Connected watch: resting HR, HRV, sleep, steps, calories, weight and watch cardio (BETA)	—	✓
Diet phase (deficit / maintenance / surplus)	—	✓
Reordering trial on a plateau	—	✓
Manual deload mode and suggested deload	—	✓
Monthly report, with its cardio section	—	✓
Body evolution: charts of your measurements and photo comparator	—	✓
Nutrition tab: two ways to follow the plan (usual diet or calorie target), weight trend, weekly review, season planner, body-fat %, foods, performance monitor, estimated burn, meal split and weekly AI menu	—	✓

In the free version the diet phase is fixed at Maintenance, autoregulation and HRV are off, and the bottom bar has three tabs instead of four (there is no Nutrition tab).

16-training-session free PRO trial

You can try every PRO feature for 16 training sessions without entering any payment details. When you tap a PRO feature, or from **Settings → PRO card**, the PRO version screen opens with the button **Try 16 training sessions free**. Tapping it turns on every feature immediately, including the Nutrition tab.

- During the trial, at certain milestones the app shows on launch how many training sessions are left and which PRO features you are using.
- When it ends, PRO features are locked and the app returns to free mode. Your routine and history are not lost. If you were using a custom routine, the app shows the preset routine again; the custom one is kept and comes back when PRO is reactivated. In the last training sessions of the trial and when it expires, the app offers to make a backup.

- The trial can be used only once.

Buying the PRO version

The PRO version screen offers three plans: monthly subscription, one-year purchase and lifetime purchase. The price is shown on the screen itself. Payments are handled by your phone's store — Google Play on Android, the App Store on iPhone— with the methods on your account. The purchase is tied to that account: if you change phone or reinstall, tap **Restore purchases**.

3. First install: the setup assistant

The first time you open TrueLift, a three-question assistant gets your routine ready. Language and weight unit are detected from your phone; you can change them later in Settings.

- **Step 1 · How many days can you train?** From 2 to 5 days. Each option shows the real structure of the routine that will be built. Choose what you can keep up every week.
- **Step 2 · How do you want to progress? Simple linear progression** (fixed reps: when you complete every set at that number, you add weight next session; recommended if you have not been training long) or **Double progression** (a rep range, for example 8-12: you keep the weight until you reach the top of the range on every set, then add weight and go back to the bottom; recommended with some experience). The «?» icon shows an example with numbers.
- **Step 3 · Your weight and the focus of the routine.** Focus **Balanced** (balance between upper and lower body) or **Lower body** (prioritises the posterior chain and glutes). Below, three fields: sex (optional; used by nutrition and the strength level), date of birth (optional; adjusts the strength-level thresholds to your age) and body weight.
- **Summary.** The **Your routine** card and the **Start training** button.

The continue button stays off until you pick an option. You can go back without losing your choices. Everything in the assistant can be changed later in **Settings → My routine**.

After the assistant, the app shows a welcome dialog and, on the first visit to each tab, a short guide. The «?» icons across the app open short explanations of each concept (section 4, Language and display).

Your first few days

When the assistant finishes, the app opens the Routine tab —not the Log— with the card Your plan is ready: days per week, estimated minutes per session and what the engine will do for you from now on. The card disappears when you dismiss it or when you save your first session.

- **When is your first workout?** Today, Tomorrow or Another day. The time is always asked, in all three options, and the app schedules a single reminder for that moment. The question never comes back.
- **See how a set is logged:** a thirty-second demo with an example set. You type weight, reps and RIR, and the app answers with the same criteria it really uses: if you fall short of the target it holds the load, if you reach it with the required RIR the weight goes up in the next session, and within a session the load never changes from one set to the next. It does not touch your history or your progression: it is an isolated example. You will find it on the card and in the Log tab as long as you have no saved session.

The app does not chain up notices: it interrupts at most once per app launch, with the most important thing at that moment; everything else is offered again next time. Each tab's guide is the exception, because it appears when you open the tab yourself: it is the answer to something you have just done.

4. Settings

It opens with the settings icon (top right). It is an index of categories in three blocks —Your training, Tracking and The app—; each line shows its current value. The app version is at the foot. The TrueLift PRO screen —trial or purchase status, website, manual download, Coach desktop app, contact, privacy policy and author— is not opened from here but with the **PRO** button in the top bar (section 5). Two decisions that used to live here are now taken from the Routine tab, which is where you look at them: the equipment available and the deload week.

My routine

Focus of the routine, sex, date of birth, progression system, training days per week and body weight, with the resulting routine card. Changes are applied with **Save changes**. If you have a custom routine, the app warns you before replacing it.

Body weight is used in bodyweight, weighted and assisted exercises, and in the strength level. Keep it up to date. With the nutrition layer on, weight updates itself from your weigh-ins and this field is locked.

Equipment available (in the Routine tab)

It opens from the Routine tab, inside the Details drop-down. Whether the weights the app proposes can actually be loaded in your gym depends on this screen.

- **1.25 kg (2.5 lb) plates:** turn it on if you have pairs of these plates. Allows 1.25 kg jumps per side on a barbell.
- **Microloading:** master switch, off by default. When on, you set the smallest plate you have (up to 2.5 kg / 5 lb) and how many per side (1 to 4, or unlimited). With the pick-up reminder, after the last exercise that uses microplates the app asks whether you have collected them.
- **Dumbbell jump:** the weight difference between one dumbbell and the next in your gym (for example, 2 kg). With **Include microloading**, smaller jumps are allowed using fractional plates on the dumbbell.
- Shortcut to the plate calculator.

Standard plates (2.5 / 5 / 10 / 20 kg and 1.25 kg if enabled) are treated as unlimited.

During the session

- **Countdown between sets:** when you log a set, the exercise's rest timer starts, with an alarm at the end. The alarm sounds even with the screen off or while you listen to music (it mixes with the audio, it does not cut it) and also with Do Not Disturb on. While it runs, the screen stays on. On iPhone, with the phone locked or outside the app, TrueLift stays awake during the rest: the beeps and the alarm play through the audio channel, also with silent mode on or with TrueLift notifications turned off, and any music you are listening to keeps its volume.
- **Minute beeps** (free, on by default): depends on the countdown. During your rest, each time a full minute goes by you hear short beeps, one per minute left: two beeps with two minutes to go and one with one minute to go. That way you know how long is left without looking at your phone. The end of the rest is still marked by the usual alarm, and the beeps also play while you listen to music.
- **Floating timer (Android):** depends on the countdown. When you leave TrueLift, a draggable capsule with the remaining time appears over whatever app you are using; tapping it brings you back to the set. Inside the app the capsule hides. The first time, Android asks for the **Display over other apps** permission; without it, the switch does not turn on. The setting's «?», always visible,

tells you which permissions are needed —on iPhone, the Live Activity ones—, where to grant them and what to check if you cannot see your rest with the phone locked.

- **Record and level alerts** (free, on by default): while you train, it celebrates each record and each new strength level with a banner and sound (section 7). Turn it off if you prefer to train without interruptions; the summary when you save the session still mentions them.

With the countdown you also see a notification with the remaining time and a button to stop it; it is what keeps the system from freezing the timer in the background. It also tells you what comes when the rest is over: the exercise drawing, its name and the next set with its weight, reps and target RIR, so you can read it with the phone locked. At the end, the **Next set!** notice arrives with the same information, silent on the phone so it does not duplicate the alarm. The app uses two notification channels, "Rest timer" and "Rest finished": if your smartwatch shows TrueLift notifications, you can allow only the second one and receive just the final notice on your wrist. That is configured in the watch's companion app, not in TrueLift. On iPhone there is no floating capsule, but there is a Live Activity: the rest, with the exercise drawing and the set that comes next, is shown on the Lock Screen and in the Dynamic Island, and you can follow it from there without opening the app. Without notifications allowed you do not see that next-set notice, but the rest still sounds.

Autoregulation and HRV

- **Autoregulation (daily readiness)** (PRO): turns on the daily check-in and readiness to train (section 11).
- **Use HRV** (PRO): depends on autoregulation. Lets you log your night HRV and resting heart rate every day. You can optionally set a low HRV threshold; otherwise the app learns your band from your own readings.
- **Read data from Health Connect** (on iPhone, **from Apple Health**) (PRO): this is what this manual calls the connected watch. It links TrueLift to your phone's health platform and uses what your watch, band or scale already measures: resting heart rate, night HRV, sleep, steps, calories, weight and your cardio workouts. Read-only, never writes, and nothing leaves the phone. It is a BETA feature. Explained in section 11.
- **Daily log reminder** (free): one daily notification at the time you choose, with whatever you have on: check-in, HRV/resting HR and weight. With nothing on, it is not scheduled, and on a day when you have already logged everything it asks for, it stays silent. On the day a new body-fat estimate is due (nutrition), the request arrives with this same reminder. If the phone has TrueLift notifications turned off, an amber line under the switch says so —on iPhone, with an **Open settings** button—; the switch keeps its value and the reminders come back on their own as soon as you allow them. The same goes for the monthly measurements reminder and the weekly review reminder.
- **Health Connect / Apple Health** (free): a row of its own in the Tracking block. It explains which data TrueLift can read, what each one is used for and how to control the permissions, and the reading can be switched on from there too. You can open it without PRO, without granting permissions and without any previous data.

Nutrition

- **Diet phase** (PRO): Calorie deficit, Maintenance or Calorie surplus (section 11). With the nutrition layer on, the phase is set by the season plan and is only displayed here.
- **Turn on the nutrition layer** (PRO): opens the Nutrition tab assistant (section 16).

Deload mode (in the Routine tab)

Deload mode is no longer switched on here: it lives in the Routine tab → Routine tools → Deload week (PRO, section 12). It is not a preference but a decision about how you train this week, and that is where it is taken.

Language and display

- **Language:** Spanish, English or Portuguese (Brazil). The change is immediate.
- **Weight unit:** kg or lb. The app keeps your data precisely: switching units does not alter your history or suggestions, only what you see (1.25 kg plates are shown as 2.5 lb).
- Text size: small, standard or large.
- Help and mini-glossary: shows the «?» help buttons and the first-time explanations (RIR, effective sets, progression attempts, top set…). Turn it off if you already know the concepts. The help button is always the same across the app —a round badge with a «?»— and has the touch area accessibility guidelines ask for; the ⓘ icon is left for notices, which are decorative and are not tapped.

Backup

Export backup and Restore (section 19). The index row shows the date of the last backup. Below them, Export photos and Import photos: tracking images do not fit in the backup file, so they travel separately in a ZIP (the backup does keep their dates, poses and weights).

Scientific sources

The last row of the index opens the list of studies and public bodies behind the app's recommendations: basal metabolism from lean mass, body-fat % with the US Navy method, the energy equivalence of body weight, daily protein, deficit and surplus rates, load progression, the RIR/RPE scale, weekly volume, deloads, HRV and sleep. Each row opens the original source. It can also be reached from the nutrition layer's legal notice.

5. The tabs

The bottom bar has three tabs in the free version and four with PRO and the nutrition layer on.

- Routine: your plan by session, with exercises, sets, reps, RIR and rest. This is where you edit it, and this is also where weekly volume and frequency, the equipment available, the deload week and the rest of the routine tools live.
- **Log:** where you log every session. When the app opens it is already on the session that is due. Includes history and cardio.
- Progress: last-session verdict, overall assessment, charts, personal records, strength level, monthly report and your body (measurements and progress photos).
- **Nutrition (PRO):** your plan (usual diet or calorie target, with the meal split and the weekly AI menu), daily weight, how you are doing, weekly review and season plan.

The top bar tells you which tab you are in. Top right, in any tab, are the **PRO** button and Settings. The PRO button opens the TrueLift PRO screen and its colour shows your status at a glance: green with PRO bought or subscribed, amber during the trial and crossed out without PRO. The plate calculator is no longer in the bar: it opens from Routine → Details → Equipment available, and every set has its own plates button (section 7). While a strength session is under way the top bar disappears, leaving the whole screen for training, and comes back when you save or discard.

6. Routine tab

The session

At the top is your routine's name, with a pencil beside it to change it. Below, the Details drop-down gathers into one card, folded by default, three things you look at now and then: the routine structure (focus, days per week and progression system), the equipment available and a summary of the session you have open —estimated duration, number of sets and the split by primary muscle group—. Each line states how it is set right now and opens the screen that changes it. Under the drop-down, two buttons lead to Volume and Frequency (section 13). Further down, the sessions appear as tabs of equal width, all in the same typeface and size.

Each exercise takes a card with its thumbnail, its order number, the name, the primary group and a line with sets × reps · RIR · rest. Tapping it expands the card (only one at a time) and shows the groups worked (primary in green, secondary at ×0.5), the library note, the TECHNIQUE button when that exercise has a video (see below) and the editing panel:

- **Sets** and **rest** with + / − buttons, **rep range** and **RIR** as chips (PRO).
- **Set mode:** Top set + back-offs, Drop set (PRO) and Superset with previous (PRO). Each exercise uses only one; see below.
- **Change exercise** and the bin to remove it (removing is PRO and asks for confirmation).

Reorder (PRO): drag the exercise from the handle on the right, or long-press the card for two seconds. Session tabs can be dragged too. Reordering does not alter your history or your progression references.

Below the list: **Add exercise** (PRO) and **Rename** the session (PRO; keeps that session's history).

Reset performance baseline (free): in the expanded card, under Change exercise. Use it when something changes enough that your earlier sessions of that exercise are no longer a fair comparison: a different machine with the same name, a different technique or coming back from an injury. From then on the exercise stops being compared with the past and the app builds a new baseline, as with a newly added exercise. Your history, records, charts and proposed weight are kept. It asks for a double confirmation and does not appear on exercises that are not scored for performance, such as those measured by time.

Exercise picker

Opens with **Change exercise** or when adding one. It is a two-column grid with the drawing of each exercise and its groups.

- **Search** across the whole library, accent-insensitive. With text, the pattern filter is ignored.
- **Equipment filters:** All, Barbell, Dumbbell, Machine, Cable.
- The **In your routine** badge marks the exercises you already use.
- You choose in two taps: select, then confirm at the bottom. The «?» opens the exercise card (enlargeable drawing, groups and note).
- **Change pattern** (PRO): in the sheet header (for example, from horizontal push to vertical push).
- Exercises you created can be edited and deleted from their drawing.

In the free version you can only swap an exercise for another of the same pattern and group.

Technique video

Many of the library's exercises carry a TECHNIQUE button that opens that movement's video in Sergio M Coach's hypertrophy library, linked with his express permission. You will find it on the expanded card in the routine editor, on the exercise sheet in the picker and, during the session, in the header of the exercise you are on and in the preview: technique doubts turn up with the bar in your hands, not while hunting through a menu.

The video opens in a window inside TrueLift: close it with a gesture and you are back on the set you were on. Exercises without a video —your own ones among them— carry no button, because a link showing a different movement confuses more than its absence.

Top set + back-offs

On main exercises, the editing panel shows the Top set + back-offs switch, also available in the free version, with two settings: % back-off (5 to 30 %, in steps of 5) and Back-off RIR (0 to 4). Set 1 is the top set: the heaviest, with the lowest RIR, and the only one that drives the exercise's progression. The rest are back-offs: lower weight by the chosen percentage, with their own target RIR.

In the log, the back-off weight is filled in from the top and rounded to your equipment. If you change the top kg, the back-offs follow; if you edit a back-off by hand, it is respected and the app remembers it for the next session as long as the top does not change. Back-offs have no rep range: you do as many as you need to reach their target RIR. When the top progresses, the back-offs get a new weight and the app proposes the number of reps estimated from that same set in the previous session; it is a guide, the RIR rules.

The first time you turn the switch on, and the first time you log a top set, the app explains the method.

Drop sets (PRO)

A drop set is a set taken to the limit and then extended by lowering the weight without resting. The first set is the normal one —the heaviest— and, as soon as you finish it, you drop the load by the configured percentage and keep going; each drop starts from the previous set, in a cascade, and is trained to failure or very close to it (RIR 0). You only rest after the last drop.

It is switched on with the Drop set toggle in the editing panel, with the % drop setting (5 to 30 %, 15 % by default). That percentage is a guide, not an exact figure: when you log, the app picks, close to that drop, weights you can load in seconds (section 7). At least two sets are required and it is not available on exercises measured by time. With the drop set on, the rep target is a specific number, not a range, also in double progression: it is the target of the first set, which is the one that decides progression, and the editor shows a single Reps selector. If you remove the drop set, in double progression it becomes a range again that ends at that figure.

What it is for. Packing stimulus and work into very little time: you extend the set beyond the point where you can no longer move that weight, without changing exercise or moving anywhere else in the gym.

Pros. A lot of volume and a lot of metabolic fatigue in a few minutes. Useful when you are short of time or want to finish off a muscle group at the end of the session.

Cons. It is an intense, very fatiguing technique: used badly it takes away more than it gives. Use it wisely and preferably on isolation exercises or machines, where failing is safe; on the big free-barbell lifts it is not a good idea. Do not put it on every exercise or in every session.

How the app treats it. Progression is decided by the first set alone, exactly as with the top set in top + back-offs: when you complete its target reps at that weight, the weight goes up. The drops are logged for reference only: they count towards your volume and tonnage, but they do not score performance

or set records. They are done under so much accumulated fatigue that comparing them week to week would say nothing, and putting them into the average was triggering deload suggestions that were not warranted.

Incompatibilities. Each exercise uses a single mode. Drop set, top set + back-offs and rest-pause are mutually exclusive: turning one on turns the others off. And an exercise inside a superset is trained with straight sets, so within a superset the drop set switch stays off, with the reason written underneath; if you want the drop set, remove the superset first.

Supersets (PRO)

A superset groups two or more consecutive exercises of the session in order to alternate their sets: 1st of the first, 1st of the second, 2nd of the first… It is switched on with the Superset with previous toggle, which links the exercise to the one above it; it does not appear on the first exercise of the day. Linking several consecutive lines builds groups of three or more, and the cards show the chip Superset 1, Superset 2…

A superset is a link, not a number: if you reorder, remove or swap exercises, the groups rebuild themselves and no orphan numbers are ever left behind.

What it is for. Saving time and keeping the pace: while one muscle group rests, you work another. The usual pairing is two exercises that do not compete with each other (a pull and a press, or a big lift and an isolation exercise for a different area).

Pros. Less dead time and a shorter session with the same volume, with your heart rate up from start to finish.

Cons. If you pair two demanding exercises that compete for the same thing, the second one suffers and the load ends up dropping. You need both pieces of equipment free at the same time, which is not always possible in a busy gym. On heavy compound lifts it usually takes away more than it gives.

How the app treats it. Progression does not change at all: each exercise keeps its own engine, its loads and its targets. The only thing that changes is the order in which the sets are performed. While logging, once you record a set the app takes you to the partner exercise by itself, with the usual rest between sets; the session is considered finished when no set of the day is left pending, not when the last exercise on the list closes. The reordering trial for plateaus does not promote exercises that are in a superset, because it would break the group.

Incompatibilities. A superset only links exercises using straight sets, on both sides of the link: if the exercise or the previous one uses top set + back-offs, a drop set or rest-pause, the Superset with previous switch stays off and the note underneath says what has to be removed and from which exercise. The other way round too: inside a superset, the top + back-offs, drop set and rest-pause switches stay off. They are different ways of distributing the load across the sets and cannot be performed at the same time.

If an old routine, an Excel file or a backup brings in an impossible combination, the app cleans it up when opening or importing it: the exercise mode wins —it is what decides how the exercise progresses — and the superset link is released, since it only decides the order.

Rest-pause (PRO)

Rest-pause splits a single effort into several short sets with the **same weight**, separated by very brief pauses. Each set goes to failure: the last rep you can complete with good form. That is why, with rest-pause on, the routine does not ask you for an RIR.

It is switched on with the **Rest-pause** toggle in the editing panel, under the drop set one. When you turn it on, the **Pause between sets** setting appears (10 to 50 seconds) and the range becomes a **Total**

rep range: what counts is the sum of reps across all the sets. At least two sets are required and it is not available on exercises measured by time. The collapsed card shows it with the RP chip.

What it is for. Packing a lot of work into little time: the short pauses are only there to squeeze out a few more reps with the same weight, without changing exercise.

Drawbacks. Like the drop set, it is demanding and tiring. Use it on isolation exercises or machines, where failing is safe, and avoid it on heavy free-weight exercises where failing is risky.

How the app handles it. When the sum of reps reaches the top of the total range —with either progression system—, next time it suggests raising the weight; if you fall short, you keep the weight and it counts as an attempt, just like any other exercise. Only the first set counts towards your performance and records; the rest add to your volume and tonnage. In a deload week or on a day with fatigue the app asks you to leave some reps in reserve. After the last set you rest as usual before the next exercise.

Incompatibilities. Rest-pause does not combine with top set + back-offs, drop set or superset: turning it on switches the others off and releases the superset. It has its own columns in the Excel template.

Routine tools

At the end of the tab there is a grid of tools in rows of two, with the PRO ones at the top:

- Deload week (PRO): start, end or extend the easy week (section 12). While it lasts, the same button is its door and a strip at the top of the tab reminds you it is under way.
- **Create with AI** (PRO): a questionnaire (sex, age, experience, goal, muscles to prioritise, days and session length, equipment you lack, current aches, structure, progression system, exercises to avoid, comments) that generates a prompt. Export your routine to Excel, paste the prompt into your AI (ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini…) attaching the file, and import the filled Excel back. Always review the result: the AI does not know your technique or your history. When in doubt, less volume and more RIR. The best option is almost always a routine from the app itself.
- PRO routines (PRO): a downloadable catalogue of complete routines ready to use as they are, shown as a grid of cards grouped by where you train (home or gym) and with filters by place and by days per week. Each card states the focus, who it is for, the level and the size of the routine —distinct exercises and sets per week—, with a colour strip that tells strength routines, lower-body-biased ones and upper-body ones apart at a glance. Tapping it opens its sheet, with the full explanation, the days, the progression system and one card per session with its exercises; you import from there with one tap.
- **Export** (free): your current routine in an Excel template, to edit on a computer or share.
- Import: loads an Excel file with the template filled in and rebuilds the routine. PRO is not required —you can edit the template on a computer or be sent someone else's routine—, but if the file brings settings the free version cannot reproduce, the app tells you. If it contains new exercises, it tells you before creating them too.
- **New exercise** (PRO): creates your own exercise with name, pattern and groups, and lets you choose whether it **progresses by** reps or by time. Timed ones work like the plank or the farmer's walk in the library: you log seconds instead of reps and they progress by lengthening the time. Once the exercise has logged sets, the type can no longer be changed, so reps and seconds never get mixed.
- Import from Hevy and Import from Strong (free): bring your history from those apps out of the file each one exports and turn it into TrueLift sessions (section 19).
- **Restore:** back to the original routine, or reset the exercise library to the original. Both explain what they delete and ask for confirmation.

The Excel template has, per day, three columns for top set + back-offs (yes/no, % back-off and back-off RIR) and more for the other modes: Superset (no.) —consecutive rows with the same number are linked—, Drop set (yes/no), % drop, Rest-pause (yes/no) and RP pause (s). Its dropdowns offer the app's full exercise library and only let you mark one mode per row, with an error message if you go outside what is allowed. If the columns are empty or say "no", they are read as straight sets, so old templates import unchanged. Your own exercises travel with their type, by reps or by time. In a drop set, reps go in a single figure.

The template travels in the app's language: in English and in Portuguese the file itself is translated too —its sheets, labels, drop-downs and error messages—, not just your data.

Before importing —a routine from the catalogue, an Excel template or a history from Hevy or Strong— the app offers to make a backup, one tap away and without leaving the process. And it tells you in advance what happens to your loads: importing a routine that keeps the split, the progression system and the number of sessions keeps the weights the app was already proposing; if any of those three changes, the proposed weights start over. Either way your history and your records are kept, and when they start over the exercise card still shows, for reference, the weight you were training it with in the previous routine.

7. Log tab: new session

Before starting

- If autoregulation is on and you have not done today's check-in yet, the app offers it on the first launch of the day (section 11). **Not now** is a valid answer.
- If you come back after a break of 2 to 8 weeks, the app asks how to resume: **Modulated return** (slightly reduces the load to regain your level in one or two weeks) or **Pick up where you left off**. After more than 8 weeks, the first sessions rebuild your level and weights are entered by hand.
- At the top you choose the session; a dot marks the one that is due (the one after the last saved). Each session progresses separately.
- Each exercise card shows the day's target (sets × reps · RIR), the **prev.** reference (weight and reps of the last valid session) and the proposed weight, always loadable with your equipment.
- Tap the card —or its arrow— and the exercise expands right there with its full plan: today's swap note if it has one, the load proposal and the set table, each set with its target, its weight and its RIR. Expanding is only for looking: it does not start the session or log anything. The drawing opens full screen with a tap, and the technique icon opens the video without folding the card.
- The list is dimmed until you tap **Start session**. From that moment the duration is measured.

If the last session cannot be used as a reference (deload, amber or red day, intensity reduced by fatigue), the card says so and points to the full-intensity session the proposal is based on.

The header

With the session under way, the top bar and the Strength/Cardio selector disappear: the whole screen is left for training, and they come back when you save, discard or switch session. First comes a fixed row with the View session button on the left and, on the right, sets done out of the total and the time left in the session; tapping the time swaps it for the estimated finishing time. Below, the header of the exercise you are on: its small drawing —a tap enlarges it—, the name, today's target, the TECHNIQUE button if there is a video and, with autoregulation on, the readiness chip.

While the rest runs, the countdown takes the place of the set counter, with Skip beside it and OK when it reaches zero, and the time left in the session stays in view. The figure warns by colour before it

sounds: green while there is plenty of rest left, amber as the end approaches, red for the short stretch and with a soft blink in the final seconds, so you can catch it out of the corner of your eye from the machine without reading the numbers. With minute beeps on, you also hear every full minute that goes by (section 4). At zero the usual alarm sounds and the figure turns green again: the rest is done.

Logging a set

Each exercise has three states: done (collapsed, with its result), active (expanded) and pending (collapsed). Tap a collapsed one to open it. On the active card:

- **Progression attempts:** small bars under the name. Each is an attempt to hit the rep target with the current weight; amber for those left, dimmed for those used. The «?» explains it.
- **Load proposal:** the collapsible message with the weight and the reason.
- **Set table:** done sets with their result; pending ones with target, proposed weight and proposed RIR.
- The set pills are the exercise's navigation bar: tap one already logged to correct it, tap the current one to come back to it from anywhere else, and tap one that has not arrived yet to look at it —with the load, reps and RIR the app proposes, and the plate breakdown— without being able to change it. From a future set, the big button takes you back to the current one.
- **Entry panel:** weight (± buttons in 0.25 steps of your unit; tap the figure to type), reps (± buttons) and five RIR buttons around the proposed one. Tap **Log set N of M**. If the countdown is on, the rest starts.
- **Plates button:** at the top right of the current set box, whenever the load is built with plates. It opens the breakdown of that exact load and, one tap away, its warm-up sets (see below).

After logging the last set, the exercise verdict appears: your performance against your baseline in that exercise. If you hit the target reps but with an RIR below the planned one, the verdict explains why the load consolidates instead of going up: you finished closer to failure than planned, so that weight still demands more of you than the plan says. Next time repeat the load and reach the same reps while leaving the planned margin, and then it will go up. It closes with a tap.

Records and levels, as they happen. If, on completing a main exercise, you beat your best estimated 1RM, a gold banner with applause appears. And the first time you reach a strength level —in an exercise or in a muscle group— a banner of its own appears, in that level's colour and with its own sound; if the same set also lifts a muscle group, it is listed underneath. If both coincide, the level banner waits for the record one to finish. Only what you achieve on a green day is celebrated, and exercises done with discomfort or swapped just for today do not count; a level you already had and win back is not celebrated again. They are turned off in Settings → During the session → Record and level alerts.

How to log well. Enter the real reps and the real RIR of every set, one by one. Do not do extra reps to "force" a lower RIR: if the target was 10 at RIR 1 and you reach 10 with RIR 2, log 10 and RIR 2. You progress when you hit the reps on every set and the RIR is equal to or higher than the target. If you do not log the RIR, the app only applies a minimal, cautious increase until it gets that figure back.

Plates and warm-up sets, without leaving the set

The plates button in the panel opens the plate calculator, but already filled in with the exercise and the load in front of you: nothing to type.

- **Plates:** what to load on each side of the bar —subtracting the bar weight, which you pick once and is remembered— or, on machines and cable stations loaded on one side, the full breakdown.

It only uses the plates you declared in Routine → Details → Equipment available, so what it proposes really can be loaded; if the load cannot be made exactly, it says so.

- **Starting fixed weight** (machines): on stack machines, cable stations, Smith machines and plate-loaded machines, the breakdown has a block for what the machine weighs before you add a single plate —the sled or carriage of a leg press, the carriage of a hack squat, the guided bar—. Choose **Fixed weight** and type that weight; it is saved for that machine and you do not have to enter it again. You keep logging only the plates or the stack, and the total you move is shown under the figure. The app takes that weight into account so that load increases and decreases, your estimated 1RM, your records, your level and tonnage reflect the real weight, and suggestions still reach you in plates; if a drop does not reach the machine's own weight, the suggestion is the empty machine. If you change it later, your previous sessions on that machine are read with the new value. It is not offered for bars, dumbbells, bodyweight exercises or assisted machines.
- **Warm-up:** the warm-up ramp up to that working load, in four steps (40 %, 55 %, 70 % and 85 %; two essential and two optional) with the reps coming down as the weight goes up. Each step is rounded to what you can actually load, steps that coincide after rounding are merged into one and any that already reach the working weight are dropped: warming up means building up to the set, not doing it twice. It does not appear on exercises measured by time. With a fixed weight, steps that do not reach the machine's own weight stay at EMPTY MACHINE.

The full calculator is still available from Routine → Details → Equipment available, and there the warm-up sets start from your 1RM. Here they start from the weight you are about to lift, which is the figure already known. The button is in focus mode too.

Drop sets and supersets while logging

- **Drop set:** the sets are labelled TOP, Drop 1, Drop 2… The weight of each drop is filled in automatically with a drop you can load in seconds: on a barbell and on plate-loaded machines, by taking off plates you already have on and without resorting to microplates; on stack machines, cables and dumbbells, the nearby step, preferably a round number. The configured percentage acts as a guide. If you repeat the same ladder as last time, the app proposes the same weights, including any you corrected by hand. On the first set the panel announces the planned drops so you can have the plates ready, and on each drop it tells you what to take off and what to put on per side. If you correct a drop, the following ones follow it. The suggested reps are the ones you did on that same drop last time, and the target RIR is 0 (3 during a deload). The timer does not start between drops: the rest comes after the last one.
- **Superset:** once you record a set, the card hands over control and the partner exercise is framed, so the order comes out A1 → B1 → A2 → B2… In focus mode the app jumps to the partner's page by itself and "Next:" announces its set. The rests are the usual ones.
- **Rest-pause:** the header shows the sets, the total reps to reach and RIR 0. The reps of each set are an estimate and the panel keeps telling you how many you have so far. Logging a set that is not the last one starts the short pause; after the last one, the normal rest. On the last set you see how many reps you still need to reach the total and, when you close the exercise, the verdict gives the total you achieved.
- The first time you face a set of a drop set, a superset or a rest-pause, the app explains it briefly; the «?» next to the switch tells the whole story.

Both are kept in the history in full detail: when you edit a session, the grid is titled Top / Drop 1 / Drop 2…, and the share image shows the weights set by set.

Notes and adjustments

Each card has a **Notes and adjustments** fold with:

- Free-text **notes**. The previous session's notes are shown below.
- **Pinned exercise log:** a note that belongs to the exercise rather than to the session, and that you will have in front of you in every session: seat height, grip, the machine pin… Edit it whenever you like; it stays exactly as it is until you change it.
- **Exercise not performed:** machine busy, broken or no time. It stays in the history as a record, but does not count for performance, volume, plateau or progression, and does not replace your last valid reference.
- **Trained with pain or limitations:** for when you do perform the exercise, but with pain, a niggle or any temporary limitation: a shortened range, less weight than planned, an adapted technique. The two boxes are mutually exclusive.

What the pain mark does. The exercise is still logged —weight, reps and volume are saved and counted— but the app treats it as an amber day for that exercise only: your performance is not scored, it does not use up a progression attempt, it is not used as a reference for later sessions and it cannot set a record. That way you can train lightly while you recover without your progression paying for it: once you are well again, the app picks the load back up from your last good session. If the pain comes back session after session, swap the exercise for a variation that does not hurt.

You do not have to remember to tick it. If, when you log a set, you lower the load by more than 6 % below what the progression was suggesting, the app asks whether you are training through pain: that is why a weight is lowered almost every time. It is asked once per exercise and session, and answering "no, just adjusting the weight" will not interrupt you again. The mark is still available in Notes and adjustments.

The «View session» drop-down

The View session button in the header opens a menu anchored just below it, with the session name at the top and all of the day's exercises underneath. Each row carries the exercise drawing, the sets logged out of those planned and today's target and, underneath, one tile per set with its label (S1, TOP, BACK 1, DROP 1…), the weight in large type and the reps. The tile colour tells you where each set stands: a done set is filled in lime with a tick and the reps you did; the one due now has a lime border, and the remaining ones are neutral. On assisted machines and weighted exercises, a label above the tiles says which load is meant. Tap a row to bring that exercise to the front.

On the right of each row, the mark for how it ended: a green tick on a finished exercise —with an up arrow in front if you managed to progress on it today—, a red cross and dimmed tiles on one marked as not performed, and nothing on one still pending. The exercise you are on is highlighted. At the foot of the drop-down are Save and Discard, the only two ways out of a session in progress.

Focus mode

The **Train in focus mode** button opens a full-screen view, one set at a time: the set target, the previous reference, two large weight and reps cards, the RIR row and **Log set N**. The pills at the top show the exercise's sets; swipe to move between exercises. Rest is shown as a ring. On Android you can silence notifications while it lasts (restored on exit). The session can be saved from focus mode too.

Assisted, bodyweight and weighted

On pull-ups, dips and push-ups the load field is the added weight (0 if you carry none). On assistance machines —the assisted pull-up machine and the assisted dip machine— you type the assistance as a positive number, just as the stack shows it: progressing means taking assistance away. When you

reach 0 the app treats the progression as exhausted and suggests moving to the conventional weighted version. Do not confuse the assisted dip machine (the counterweight one, where you hang and the stack helps you) with the chest dip machine (the plate-loaded one, where you sit and push): they are two different exercises in the library and are logged the other way round.

Saving the session

The session is closed from the foot of the View session drop-down:

- Save: if exercises are left unlogged or half done, the app warns you. If a weight is more than 15 % away from the proposal, it asks for confirmation in case of a typo (the drops of a drop set are not checked: they go down on purpose). With autoregulation on, it asks for the session effort (RPE from 1 to 10, preset at 5; if you do not move it, it asks you to confirm).
- **Discard:** deletes the session, with double confirmation.

On saving, the app replies with a performance message, the new record notice (if you beat your best estimated 1RM in a main exercise), the new strength level notice, the streak congratulation and, where relevant, the day's context (amber, red, deload, fatigue in one body region). This summary always appears, also with live alerts turned off.

Only one strength session per calendar day is saved. If there is one already, the app takes you to edit it. Cardio does not count towards this limit.

8. Log tab: history

The **History** tab shows:

- **Log cardio:** type (or your own name), day, duration in minutes and intensity from 1 to 10. From duration and intensity the app computes your weekly cardio load and compares it with what is usual for you; a week far above counts as a fatigue signal. Every cardio session in the history has a pencil to correct its type, day, duration or intensity without deleting it; the ones from your watch keep their heart rate and calories.
- With the connected watch, your aerobic workouts come into this list by themselves, with their real duration and an estimated intensity; the card says so and gives your average heart rate for that session. A watch cardio is edited and deleted like any other, and deleting is final: it does not come back.
- **Month calendar:** a dot per session, cardio in blue and the missed-sessions indicator against the planned ones. Tap a day to see what was logged.
- **Export to Excel** the whole history.
- **Delete all history**, with double confirmation.
- Recent sessions, each with Share (image for social media, section 18), Edit (weight, reps, RIR, notes, date, exercises not performed and exercises trained with pain) and Delete. On exercises with per-set loads, editing shows one row per set titled Top / Drop 1 / Drop 2… With PRO, each session carries its light: green, amber ("Session with modulated intensity") or red ("Session with modulated intensity and volume"); if readiness was split by body region that day, the strip says so ("Lower body limited · Upper body unrestricted"). If you logged in real time, the duration appears.
- **Sessions from previous routines:** changing routine —or importing one— does not empty the history. Everything you have trained stays in the list, the calendar and All sessions, and sessions from a previous routine carry a strip saying so ("From a previous routine · kept exactly as it was

logged"). You can view, share and delete them, but not edit them, because they were measured against another routine.

- **All sessions:** full list with an All / Strength / Cardio filter.

9. Your data is the engine

Every proposal the app makes comes from your logs. This is what it uses and why it is worth logging well:

- **Weight and reps** of every set: they feed the estimate of your strength (estimated 1RM). The app combines your best set with the whole session so that one unusually good set does not inflate the proposal. In bodyweight, weighted or assisted exercises the load includes your body weight: keep it up to date.
- **RIR** of every set: tells how far from failure you work. An inflated RIR produces weights that do not come off later. Without RIR, the app only applies minimal increases.
- **Session effort (RPE)**, with autoregulation: modulates the next increase and watches your accumulated fatigue.
- **Cardio**, with realistic duration and intensity: it is part of your total load.
- **Daily readiness and HRV** (PRO): the signals from outside the gym (section 11).
- **Daily body weight** (nutrition): drives the diet phase.

Log in the moment, set by set. RIR remembered hours later is unreliable, and only by logging in real time does the app store the session duration.

How it reads fatigue. There is no sensor: it infers it from your logs compared with what is usual for you, looking at the trend of several sessions, not one bad day. What weighs most is the real RIR of your sets, your performance against your reference, the RPE and the cardio load; with PRO, also daily readiness and HRV. A sustained build-up slows the increases and, if marked, triggers the deload suggestion.

10. How the app progresses

- If you hit the target (every set at the planned reps with RIR equal to or above the target), the app proposes adding weight. The increment is small and proportional to the exercise: more on the big basics, less on isolation.
- If you fall short, it holds the weight. If you had changed it by hand and did not progress, next session it proposes your weight, not its own. As soon as you progress, the new weight is built again from your equipment.
- The increase takes the session into account: at the limit (high RPE, borderline performance, deficit, no RIR) it adds less; with plenty in reserve, a bit more. The message says so ("moderate increase…").
- **Progression attempts:** if you use up the attempts at the same weight, it first warns that the next one is decisive; if you stay stuck, it proposes a small step back to build momentum. If the plateau returns after being overcome, it suggests temporarily swapping the exercise for an equivalent variation.
- **Reordering trial** (PRO): before the step back, if the stuck exercise is not the first of the day, the app tries one session with it moved to first place. If it works, it goes back to its place and keeps progressing; if not, the step back is applied. The other exercises of that day train normally; that session does not count as an attempt for them nor alter their progression.

- After a break of several weeks it does not demand picking up where you left off (section 7).
- The proposed weight is always loadable: on a barbell, according to the plates you have on both sides; on a machine, plate by plate; with dumbbells, according to your jump.
- Each session progresses separately: an exercise that appears on two days advances independently on each.
- Each session is assessed with the criteria of the day it was saved. Changing the diet phase later does not rewrite the past.

In double progression, you first accumulate reps within the range; when you reach the top on every set, the app adds weight and the range starts again.

11. Autoregulation and daily signals (PRO)

These features are optional. The app works without them; with them, it also decides when to push and when to hold back.

The daily check-in

With autoregulation on, the first launch of the day opens the check-in. It also opens from the status chip in the Log header. One entry per day; saving again replaces the previous one.

- Five signals on a 1 to 4 scale: **Sleep** (1 poor · 4 good), **Energy / mood** (1 low · 4 high), **Muscle soreness** (1 none · 4 severe), **Stress** (1 none · 4 high) and **Joint pain** (1 none · 4 severe). Soreness and pain ask for the zone: General, Lower or Upper.
- **Ill:** Yes / No.
- With HRV on: night HRV (ms) and resting HR (bpm), the values from your watch or band. With the connected watch (see below) they arrive already filled in and you do not have to type them. The Unreliable data box discards both for that day; the «?» beside it explains when it is worth ticking —alcohol, a night away from home, a very late dinner, travel or a badly fitted watch— and when it is not: having slept badly for no clear reason is useful information. If the numbers come from the last entry and you do not touch them, the app asks you to confirm they are today's.
- With the nutrition layer: today's weight.
- The footer shows live the 0–100 score, the label (high, medium or low readiness) and the reason with its consequence.

How to score. Score against your normal, not against an ideal. A night like the ones you usually sleep is a 4; 3 is for nights worse than usual. The same for energy. If you score your normal day as mediocre, the app will hold you back for no reason.

Soreness is not joint pain. Soreness is the diffuse muscle ache one or two days after training; it is normal. Joint pain is sharp or localised in a joint and usually appears during the movement. Log it with its zone: the app protects only the exercises of that region. A knee issue slows your squat, not your bench press.

Readiness to train

The app summarises your state in a 0 to 100 score with three bands: red (0–39), amber (40–69) and green (70–100). The chip in the Log header and the Progress card show it; tapping it shows which signals add or subtract (sleep, stress, HRV, recent performance, accumulated training and cardio load…). If your recent performance is weak, the banner says so even if the check-in is good.

- **Green:** normal session and progression allowed.

- **Amber:** loads stay as they are and the target RIR goes up by 1. When the amber comes only from mild discomfort, the app does not freeze the loads: it keeps increasing them, cautiously. If what limits you belongs to one body region only, the other trains normally (see below).
- **Red:** easy session: target RIR +2 and no increases. The app does not assess that session's performance.
- After a red day, the first day is never green: even if your signals are back to normal, the app sets a transition amber and says so. One good night after several bad days is usually the start of the recovery, not the end of it.
- Without a check-in, the app does not assume you are fine: it reminds you before proposing increases.

Readiness by body region. Some signals concern the whole body —sleep, mood, stress, illness, HRV, accumulated fatigue or performance— and others are local: joint pain and soreness carry their region. When what limits you belongs to one region only, the day is split: each region gets its own colour and score, and the free one carries on normally, with its increases, records and progression attempts. The header chip shows it according to what the day's session loads: in a session for a single region, its state and score, with the other as a small dot with its abbreviation (Up. or Low.); in one that loads both, a dot and a score per region. Tapping it, the breakdown says which region limits you and which does not. On exercises that are not affected, a discreet line says so instead of the warning. Some upper-body exercises that also load the lower body —bent-over rows, standing military press or the farmer's walk— are protected like leg exercises. Already in the check-in, if what you mark limits only one region, you see live how each one ends up. If any signal is whole-body, there is no split and the day looks as always.

You can **Force high readiness today** from the chip: you replace the calculation with your own judgement and the session is programmed with high readiness. It is a manual override; you can remove it from the same place.

HRV and resting heart rate

The app reacts to the sustained signal, not to one bad night: it takes at least two low nights in a row or a trend of several days below your band. A good night breaks the run, and the modulation switches off by itself when the average recovers. If you do not measure your HRV, leave it off.

The connected watch (PRO, BETA)

If you wear a watch or a band, TrueLift can use what it already measures instead of you typing it in. Turn it on in Settings → Autoregulation and HRV → **Read data from Health Connect** (on iPhone, **Read data from Apple Health**); it works through your phone's health platform. TrueLift does not talk to the watch: it reads whatever your watch app or your scale has left there. In Settings → Tracking there is also a row named after that platform which explains, without PRO or permissions, which data is read and what each one is used for.

- Resting heart rate, night HRV and sleep: they feed your daily readiness. The sleep question in the check-in arrives already scored from what you slept —and from how broken the night was—; you correct it if you see it differently, and the app learns from your corrections. If the night was not entirely good, the check-in opens expanded with that score already marked, so you do not overwrite it by accident with the all-good shortcut. Only the night's average counts for HRV, not the odd daytime readings.
- Steps and calories: they fine-tune the nutrition layer and feed the steps card in the Progress tab (section 14).

- Weight: if your scale writes to the platform, the day's weigh-in goes into the nutrition layer by itself. It never overwrites a weigh-in you already entered, and a big jump from your trend is put to you for confirmation before it counts.
- Workouts: the aerobic sessions your watch logs —running, cycling, rowing, swimming, elliptical, sports...— come into your history as cardio by themselves, with their real duration and an intensity estimated from your heart rate during the session and your resting rate. Walking does not come in, because steps already cover it, and neither do strength sessions, because you log those yourself. If you had already entered a similar cardio by hand that day, it is not duplicated; and a watch cardio you delete from the history does not come back.

Read-only and only on this phone: TrueLift writes nothing to the health platform and no data leaves the device. It reads when you open the app and when you come back to it, never in the background, and each time it goes over the last few days, so data that arrives late ends up coming in by itself. Whatever you do not grant is simply not read —if you have no scale, you can leave weight out and still get the rest— and a value you typed by hand is never overwritten.

If you change watch or app, HRV starts a new band. Every brand measures variability its own way, and mixing two scales would make normal nights look bad: from the changeover the app learns your band again from the new watch's nights, and the HRV chart does not cross that boundary. Your history is left untouched.

The connected watch is in BETA, and it says so in Settings. Without a watch, everything it reads is still entered by hand as always.

On some Android phones —certain Xiaomi models, for example— the system may stop TrueLift from connecting to Health Connect. If that happens, the app keeps working: the Settings card warns in amber that Health Connect is not responding and tells you to allow Health Connect and TrueLift to start automatically in the phone's settings. In the meantime, data is still entered by hand.

Diet phase

- **Calorie deficit:** you eat below maintenance. The app is more conservative with increases.
- **Maintenance:** default value and the neutral option.
- **Calorie surplus:** you eat above. The app is somewhat more permissive.

The effect grows with the weeks in the phase. If you do not control your diet, leave it at Maintenance. With the nutrition layer on, the phase comes from the current block of your season plan.

12. Deload mode (PRO)

A deload is an easy week: fewer sets, higher RIR, around 10 % less load and progression paused.

- It is started from the Routine tab → Routine tools → Deload week. When the week is up, the app asks whether you end it or keep it one more week; if you keep it, it switches itself off at the end. While it lasts, a strip at the top of the Routine tab reminds you and opens the same options.
- When it closes, progression resumes from the weights before the deload.
- With autoregulation, the app also suggests it when it detects accumulated fatigue, a drop in performance, several days in a row in poor state or a cardio week far above usual. Every so many weeks of regular training, it also asks whether your body needs one.
- During the deload, on saving each session the app confirms that it does not assess performance or use that week in your comparisons.

- After a deload there is a period without new suggestions, and pain only counts as a reason if it is recent.

13. Volume and frequency

It is no longer a tab in the bottom bar: it opens with the two buttons in the Routine tab, under the Details drop-down. The numbers are exactly the same.

Inside there are two views: Volume and Frequency. They are computed from your current selection of exercises and sets. An exercise's primary group counts ×1 and secondaries ×0.5. At the top, the Microcycle selector says in how many days you complete one full pass through your routine: 7 by default, with a minimum equal to the number of sessions and a maximum of 14. Everything the screen calls "weekly" is scaled to that length: five sessions stretched over nine days are not 20 chest sets a week, they are 15.6. The thresholds do not move; your number does. This setting only changes what you see here: progression, plateaus, deloads and reports still count sessions, not calendar days.

Volume. Two summary figures (groups in the target zone and effective sets per week) and one bar per group with the target zone drawn on it. Reference for men (for women the thresholds are 25 % higher):

Sets / week	Meaning
4 or fewer	Very low
5 – 9	Maintenance
10 – 20	Target zone (start at the low end)
21 or more	Very high: watch your recovery

Frequency. Two summary figures (groups with two or more days and workout days per week) and a group × session matrix: solid green cell if the group is primary in that session, light green if secondary, grey if not worked. The Days column counts only the sessions where the group is primary. Training each group two or more days a week is usually preferable.

Real volume logged

Below both tabs there is a chart with the effective sets you have actually logged per week, since your first saved session. They are counted like the plan (primary 1, secondary 0.5), but only sets with recorded data: this is what you did, not what was planned.

- Range: 3 months, 1 year or your whole history.
- Group: the total or a specific muscle group. With a group selected, the green band is its target zone and the dashed line is what your routine plans for that group each week; in the Total view, the line is the planned total. If your routine does not work that group, there is no line.
- Tap a bar to see which week it is and its exact figure.
- The chart joins your whole history even if you changed routines: the vertical dotted lines mark each change. Weeks without training count as zero, because a break is also part of the story.

14. Progress tab

From top to bottom:

- **Monthly report** (PRO): a button that opens the report of the last closed month (see below).

- **Last-session verdict:** percentage against your baseline, a one-line reading, a mini chart of the last seven sessions, and tonnage, sets, RPE and duration.
- **Recent readiness** and **Readiness to train** (with autoregulation): your last days in green, amber and red; non-green days show the zone with a letter (G general, L lower, U upper), and the chart of the daily score.
- **Overall assessment:** a combined reading of your last sessions (improving, holding, dropping or mixed), with the context of your diet phase, your weight pace and your recovery when there is data, and what the app is already doing about it. It appears from three assessable sessions. During a deload it does not assess.
- **Session performance** and **Net daily performance:** whether you perform above or below your reference. The charts keep the history when you change routine; a dashed line marks each change. The «?» explains the reference lines.
- **HRV per day** and **Resting HR** (with HRV on).
- **Steps per day** (with the connected watch): one bar per day against your goal, in green, amber or red depending on how the day ended, with today dimmed because it is still half done. A day with no data is left empty: a watch you did not wear is not a day without steps. Below, two lines with what helps you decide: this week's goal and your average steps this week —not counting today— against last week's. The «?» explains where the goal comes from.
- **Cardio by week** (if you have logged cardio): one bar per week with your cardio minutes, the average intensity on top and a colour that tells you how much it weighed on your readiness to train: green if light, amber if moderate and red if high. The current week is dimmed. Without autoregulation, the bars are a neutral colour and the card does not talk about impact.
- **Personal records:** your best estimated 1RM per exercise. Only the big compound lifts (squats, deadlift, presses, pull-ups/pulldowns and rows).
- **Tonnage per session**, by session type.
- Per exercise (dropdown): **estimated 1RM**, **load**, **estimated e1RM per session** and **total reps per session**. The e1RM is estimated from your sets with a standard formula that accounts for RIR; in bodyweight exercises it includes your weight. On machines with a starting fixed weight it includes that weight, although the load chart still shows the plates you log. The dropdown remembers the last exercise you looked at, also after closing and reopening the app.
- **Your body:** the card at the end opens your body measurements and your progress photos (section 15).

Your level

Classifies your strength per exercise by comparing your best estimated 1RM with your body weight, against common standards by sex and age: Beginner, Novice, Intermediate, Advanced and Elite.

- Exercises with loads comparable across gyms score: squat (back and front), barbell and dumbbell bench press, deadlift (conventional, Romanian, sumo and trap bar), barbell and dumbbell overhead press, barbell and dumbbell incline press, pull-ups (pronated, supinated and assisted), barbell row and Pendlay row, dips, hip thrust and Bulgarian split squat. Machines, cables, Smith machine, leg press and hack squat do not score: their load depends on the manufacturer.
- **Overall level:** the average of your exercises with a record; it needs at least three exercises from two different patterns. A five-segment bar shows the level reached and the progress towards the next.
- Each row says how many kilos you are short of the next level.

- **Progress · 3 months:** per exercise, your relative strength three months ago against now and its change. With the nutrition layer it uses your trend weight back then; otherwise, your current weight on both dates.
- Thresholds adjust to your sex and age (date of birth). If you have not declared them, the card says what it assumes and links to **Settings → My routine**.
- By muscle group: besides the per-exercise rows, one row per group —chest, back, quads…— with its estimated level. Each exercise's level is shared out among the muscles that move it, so a group's level is the average of the scored exercises that work it; below, which ones. A group with no scored exercises shows as No data and suggests which to log so it can be assessed, and one estimated from few exercises says so. Above the block, your strongest and weakest group. It is indicative: it is there to show imbalances, not to compete.

When you save a green session that moves an exercise up a level, the app announces it.

Monthly report (PRO)

Only for closed months: while the month is in progress there is no report. It opens the last closed month and, from inside, any previous month with data. It includes:

- **Consistency:** month calendar with each session's light, weekly summary, streak, complete weeks, longest break and deloads.
- **Strength progress:** records of the month, 1RM table of the main lifts, load moved, reps, sets and split by group.
- **Quality of the month** (with autoregulation): split by light, verdicts, average readiness, duration, RPE and days with a signal.
- **Body** (with nutrition): trend weight, pace against the phase target, weigh-ins, body-fat %, phase and block.
- **Cardio and recovery** (if there was cardio in the month): sessions, minutes and average intensity for the month, one row per week with how much it weighed on your recovery (light, moderate or high) and a sentence on what it means. If any week weighed heavily, it also shows up in the conclusions.
- **Comparison** with the previous month and conclusions.

It can be shared as HTML with the share icon. Cardio has its own section; the strength figures (sessions, load, records) do not include it.

15. Your body: measurements and progress photos

The scale and your 1RM do not tell the whole story. This module keeps your girths and your tracking photos so you can see the change in shape, not just the number. It opens from the Your body card at the end of the Progress tab.

Measurements

Fourteen sites: neck, shoulders, chest, left and right biceps, left and right forearm, waist, abdomen, hips, left and right thigh, and left and right calf. You do not have to fill them all in: log the ones you care about.

- Log measurements opens the form with the date —you can log a measurement taken on another day— and whichever sites you want. Two measurements of the same site on the same day replace each other.
- The list shows the latest value of each site and its difference from the previous one.

- Tapping a site opens its detail: the chart of its evolution (PRO) and the full history, with row-by-row deletion.
- Measurements are always stored in centimetres; if your weight unit is the pound, they are shown in inches. Changing unit does not alter anything that is stored.

Measure in the morning, without clothes and without squeezing the tape: only then are measurements comparable with each other.

The **How to measure** button opens an illustrated guide with the exact spot for each measurement and how to place the tape; you can also reach it from the measurement form and from each point. The waist guide adapts to the sex in your profile, because that is the reference the body-fat estimator uses.

Neck, waist and hips are the same ones used by the girth-based body-fat estimator in the nutrition layer: they arrive pre-filled with whatever you have already measured, and whatever you measure there is saved here. There cannot be two different waists.

Progress photos

- Add photo: with the camera or from the gallery, choosing the pose (front, side or back). The app rescales and recompresses the image so it does not take up more space than needed, and stores the date and your weight on that day with it.
- Photos are stored only on this phone, in the app's private storage, outside your gallery.
- The grid shows them by date; tapping one opens it full screen, with zoom and the option to delete it.
- **Compare** (PRO): two photos of the same pose —by default, the first and the last— side by side, as a curtain (the new one covers the old one as far as you drag) or overlaid, with the days elapsed and the weight difference between them. It can be shared as an image (section 18).

Same pose, same light, same time of day. One photo every four weeks says far more than one a week. The **How to take photos** button opens an illustrated guide covering the time, place, camera, light, clothing and posture so your photos are comparable with each other.

Reminder and backup

- Monthly reminder (optional): one nudge a month for measurements and a photo, about thirty days after the last ones.
- Measurements and the photo index (dates, poses and weights) travel in the normal backup. The images do not fit there: they are exported and imported separately, in a ZIP, from Settings → Backup. If you restore a backup without that ZIP, the photo entry shows a gap, not an error.

Logging measurements, seeing the latest figure, taking photos and viewing them in the grid are free. The evolution charts and the photo comparator are PRO.

16. Nutrition tab (PRO)

The nutrition layer works alongside your training. You weigh yourself every day; once a week the app reviews whether to adjust your food or your activity so your weight moves at the planned pace. You do not log meals and there is no food database. You can follow its guidance in two ways: adjusting your usual diet, without counting calories, or following a daily calorie target, split into macros and meals, which you can turn into a weekly menu with your preferred AI.

What it does and does not do

- Tracks your weight, filters the daily noise and computes your real rate of change.

- Once a week compares that rate with your target and, if needed, proposes an adjustment in grams of your own foods or in daily steps.
- Coordinates with training: protects the stimulus if your performance drops and aligns refeeds with deloads.
- It does not log what you eat, does not score foods and does not check whether your diet is complete. The meal split and the AI menu are indicative guides: they are not a diet or a nutrition plan, and they do not replace a professional.

Requirements and notice

The activation assistant requires ticking two boxes:

- **Reasonably structured and consistent eating.** Proposals are adjustments relative to what you ate the previous week. You do not need to know your calories, but you do need to be able to say whether this week you ate roughly like the last. If your eating is irregular, do not turn the layer on.
- **Legal notice.** It is for healthy adults. Do not use it if you are under 18, pregnant or breastfeeding, have or have had an eating disorder, are underweight, have an illness or take medication that affects weight, metabolism or nutritional needs. Estimates can be wrong. The app does not diagnose or treat illness and does not guarantee results. You decide: discard any proposal that contradicts a professional. If discomfort, dizziness, weakness, menstrual changes or a worrying weight change appears, stop applying the recommendations and seek professional help.

Activation: the assistant

Seven screens, one decision per screen. Nothing is saved until you tap **Turn on**.

- **1 · What this is:** explanation and the two boxes. The full legal notice opens from its own box.
- **2 · Your measurements:** height, years of strength training experience and, if you like, what your work is like (seated, on your feet or physical), which refines what you burn in daily life; if you leave it blank, a seated job is assumed. Sex is taken from the one declared in Settings.
- **3 · Body-fat %:** required, but you do not need to know it: three methods open the estimator (see **Your data**).
- **4 · Which block:** Bulk, Maintenance or Cut, and whether you have been in that same phase for less than 3 weeks or 3 or more (shortens calibration).
- **5 · Pace:** percentage of your weight to change per week, with a colour band (green recommended, amber reasonable, red aggressive), the projected weight and body-fat % and the estimated split between fat and lean mass.
- **6 · Last details** (optional): foods, approximate usual intake ("I don't know" is valid), menstrual cycle mode and weekly card notice.
- **7 · Summary:** the first block, its projection and the reminder that for the first days the app only observes. If you already follow a calorie target and change the pace of the current phase, the summary shows what your daily target will become.

On activation the phase and the first block of the season plan are created, and then you choose how to follow your plan.

How you follow your plan

TrueLift lets you choose how to follow its guidance. You choose at the end of the assistant and can change it whenever you like with **Change** on the Your current plan card or from the **How you follow**

your plan row of the management index; nothing changes until you tap **Confirm**. Your history, your stage and your agreed steps are kept.

- **Adjust my usual diet:** for people who eat in a similar way almost every day and do not want to count calories. You keep your usual diet and the weekly review suggests concrete changes —a little more or less of a food, or more steps— which you apply yourself. The app does not give you a daily figure: changes are always relative to what you already eat.
- **Follow a calorie target:** for people whose eating varies from day to day or who want more precise control. You get a daily figure, the same every day, split into macros and meals, which reviews update when you accept their proposals. When you choose it, the app offers a figure estimated from your data —or the one you were already following— and you can adjust it if you know how many calories you want to follow.

When you move from your usual diet to a calorie target you start with a new figure: the changes you accepted on your usual diet are not added again. When you move to the usual diet, what you eat now becomes your starting point, your agreed steps are kept and the meal split and the menu stop showing a daily figure until you set a target again.

If you already used the nutrition layer with an earlier version of the app, the **Choose how to follow your plan** card asks how you were using it. Until you choose, your plan does not change, you can keep weighing yourself as usual and the weekly review stays on hold.

The tab

It is organised in five blocks. The header shows the current phase and week and gives access to the phase settings. While you have not chosen how to follow your plan, the **Choose how to follow your plan** card appears at the very top.

- **Your current plan:** how you follow it, with **Change**, and what to eat. With a calorie target, a single large figure, **Your daily target**, with the date it applies from, and the **Meal plan and menu**, **Customize** and, if you have customized it, **Back to recommended** buttons; if there is a proposal you have not accepted, it reminds you that until then you keep this target. With the usual diet, the last agreed change —or that there is none yet— and the agreed steps. Right below, **Today weight**: a large figure that opens the keyboard, a strip of the last seven days and the count of weigh-ins this week; **Another day** logs a late weigh-in with its date.
- **How you are doing:** your planned pace and your trend, in two figures, with a sentence that sums it up: as planned, faster, slower or in the opposite direction. It is an indicative reading —whatever needs changing is proposed by the weekly review— and while the phase is calibrating it compares nothing. Below, the **Weight trend** chart: your weigh-ins (dots), your trend weight (line) and the target (dashed); weigh-ins inside a refeed window or after a pause are drawn hollow: they do not move the trend.
- **Weekly review:** the card where the app proposes adjustments (see below).
- **Your stage and planning:** the stage card, with the **Calibrated** or **Calibrating** badge, the week of the block and when it ends, and a table with weight, body-fat % and lean mass with the block's Start, Target and Change columns; the **Season** card, a bar of blocks proportional to the calendar that opens the planner; and the fat-free mass and body-fat % charts, estimated from your weight trend, with your real measurements and the projection.
- **Details and history:** Where your target comes from, Your estimated burn and Previous decisions (see below).
- **Management index:** Your data, How you follow your plan, Phase settings, Performance monitor and Your foods. When the weekly review has a proposal on screen, Your foods also opens from the card itself.

The charts are interactive: pinch to zoom, drag to pan, tap a point to see its date and value, double-tap to return to the full view. The axis also keeps what came before the current stage: dragging back brings up the previous block's weeks, at the same scale, so that starting a new block does not wipe everything earlier out of view.

Weighing yourself every day

It is your only daily task. Weigh yourself fasted, after going to the bathroom, before drinking and without clothes. Repeating the conditions matters more than the exact time. A single day goes up and down with water, salt, glycogen or the menstrual cycle; that is why the app looks at the trend weight, not the single number. One weigh-in per day; if you make a mistake, edit or delete it from the list. If a reading is far from the previous one, the app asks for confirmation.

Calibration

When a phase starts, the app gathers data and proposes no changes until your weight trend is reliable; it is shorter if you said you had already been in the same phase for a while. Meanwhile, the weekly review shows **Waiting for data**, with the estimated date of the first review once it is known. Every block change recalibrates: moving from a bulk to a cut, weight jumps because of water and glycogen, which is not fat.

The weekly review

It is the only place where the app proposes adjustments. It arrives once a week and what it brings is a proposal: your plan does not change until you accept it. It can say:

- **Keep:** your pace is on track. Change nothing; your target stays the same.
- **Downward adjustment:** the daily kcal to cut and several ways to get there: **Move more** (daily steps computed from your data; the best route whenever you can take it on), diet (cut carbohydrates, or carbohydrates and fats, with examples from your foods or from the app's basics; protein is not cut), **Activity and diet** (half and half) and **Your own mix** (choose one or two foods and split the kcal between them; if you like, cover part of it by walking). When the phase already carries many recommended steps, only diet remains.
- The activity-only route has a ceiling: it is offered while the resulting day —what you already walk plus what would be asked— stays within your **daily step limit**, which you choose in Your data and which applies from the next card. If it does not fit, the card offers diet or a mix of the two, and the **Change step limit** link takes you to adjust it. Without a connected watch the app assumes an ordinary day, so as not to ask you for more steps than make sense.
- **Upward adjustment:** raise calories, prioritising carbohydrates. Reducing activity is never proposed.
- **Refeed and deload:** after a long deficit, two days with more carbohydrates coordinated with a training deload. The card shows the refeed dates, until which day weigh-ins do not move the trend, and whether it is in progress or completed.
- **Protecting the stimulus:** a training volume cut (see coordination).
- **Target safely adjusted** or **This phase is over:** the loop has reached its safety cap. The app proposes setting up the next phase.

With a calorie target, the card shows your **Current target** and, below it, what it would become **With the proposal**, as a preview of the chosen option; if you take it through activity, your food target does not change and you walk more. The kcal are the same every day. With the usual diet, the change is relative to what you are eating and walking now, and you can apply it every day or concentrate the

week's total on one or two days that suit you, leaving the rest unchanged; it repeats every week until the next review.

The card closes with **Apply** or **Postpone**. Apply adds the change to your plan from that day, just once, and is not scored; the card confirms where your target ends up, or the extra steps if you take it through activity. Postpone leaves it in view without changing anything, and you can accept it until the next review. If your plan changes before you accept it —your stage, your pace, your target or how you follow it—, the proposal expires without being applied, and a more recent review replaces the previous one. The food examples are ways of making the change, not a separate cut: with a calorie target, your target and its split already include it. At the foot of the card, the **Your foods** button opens your library, which is what the adjustment's grams are expressed in.

Have you been able to keep up the previous change? With the usual diet, before proposing a new change on top of one you accepted, the card asks you: Yes, most days · Partly · Barely · Not sure. With Yes or Not sure you see the usual proposal; with Partly or Barely, nothing is added that week: the card says **No new changes this week**, you keep the change you already had and your plan does not change. It is not a score and it is not compared with anything, and you can **Change my answer** while the card is that week's.

After you accept a change, the app gives it time to show before assessing again: the card shows **Giving your last change time** with the date of the next review. If there is no clean signal (few weigh-ins or a water window), the assessment is postponed and the card says so. And while you have not chosen how to follow your plan, it stays at **Review on hold**.

Your daily target and your estimated burn

With a calorie target, **Your daily target** is a single figure, the same one used by the macro and meal split and by the AI menu. It only changes with a decision: when you accept a review, customize it or change stage, pace or the way you follow the plan. A weigh-in or the day's activity does not move it. **Customize** lets you type another figure: it is saved as your difference from the recommendation, later reviews keep it and **Back to recommended** removes it. If you have a proposal you have not accepted, customizing discards it and the next review starts from your new figure. It never suggests eating less than your body burns at rest.

In **Details and history**, **Where your target comes from** breaks it down step by step —starting point, change for your stage, accepted reviews, rounding, recommended, your customization and limit applied— and the rows add up exactly to the figure you see. **Previous decisions** lists your latest decisions with their date and where each one left you.

Your estimated burn is an informative figure calculated with formulas, not a measurement: it adds up what your body burns at rest, your daily life according to your work, your steps, your strength and cardio sessions, and digestion, and it says what it assumes when a piece of data is missing (your steps without a watch, your work not stated, your body composition not measured). Right there you can answer **What is your work like?** (seated, on your feet or physical). It does not move your target. With a calorie target kept long enough, the How you are doing card asks whether you have followed it (Yes, roughly · I did not · Not sure); if you say yes, the **Estimate from your plan and your weight** appears: what your scale says you burn, if you followed your target as you told us. The answer is only used for that estimate and you do not need to have followed it to the letter. With the usual diet it is not estimated, because the app does not know how much you eat.

The meal split

The **Meal plan and menu** button on the Your current plan card opens the **Meal split**: your daily target split into protein, carbs and fat, and across the meals you choose. It is the same target you see on the

main screen. If you adjust your usual diet there is no daily figure to split: the screen says so and offers **Set a daily target**.

- **Daily macros:** protein and fat are chosen with two sliders that only cover the recommended range, and carbs adjust on their own to match the calories. Each macro is shown in grams and in g/kg of your target weight. Protein is the same as in the weekly card's protein reminder.
- **Meals:** you choose how many you eat a day, from 3 to 5, and each one shows its name (breakfast, lunch, snack…), its kcal and its grams of protein, carbs and fat. With − and + you make a meal smaller or bigger and the others adjust on their own; **Back to the starting split** undoes those changes.
- **Before and after training:** mark the meal before and the meal after your workout. They get more carbs and a little less fat than the rest, to perform and recover better. If a marked meal is too light for that, the screen suggests making it bigger with +.
- **Correct the day's kcal:** the pencil next to the kcal is the same edit as **Customize**: you type another figure if you prefer to eat something different from the recommendation, macros and meals are recalculated and the screen shows that the kcal are corrected next to the recommendation. It is saved as your difference from the recommendation, so later reviews can change your target and your correction stays. **Back to recommended** removes it.

The amounts are the same every day, whether you train or not, and the split only changes when your target changes. It is a guide for people who weigh their food: no meals are logged and the scale still has the final say.

Create your weekly menu with AI

From the meal split, the **Create your weekly menu with AI** button turns your split into a prompt for the AI you prefer (ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini…), just as Create with AI does for the routine. TrueLift does not call any AI: it prepares the text on your phone and you decide whether to copy or share it.

- A four-step assistant: your diet and the conditions of use (allergies, intolerances and foods you cannot have, eating pattern —vegetarian, vegan…— and country); your preferences and your kitchen (foods to avoid and to prioritise, budget, supermarket, cooking time and skill, equipment at home and at work); how your week is organised (start date, meal times, meals out, training days, people eating with you, batch cooking…); and a final review.
- Before copying it you see the full prompt. It carries your phase, goal and pace, the current split (kcal, macros and meals, including the ones before and after training) and a summary of your recent training. Your weight, height, age and sex are shown so you can confirm whether to include them. Your date of birth, name, photos, measurements and HRV never leave.
- The AI will give you back a seven-day menu with quantities, recipes, a shopping list and substitutions. It is indicative: TrueLift does not verify its recipes or calculations, so review it, especially if you have allergies or intolerances.
- Your answers are saved in TrueLift and in your backup for next time, and they are not sent to analytics. It is for healthy adults and does not generate therapeutic diets; if the phase is paused or there is a refeed on those dates, the app tells you first. If the chosen week crosses a change of stage or pace in the plan, it asks you to pick another week or wait for the new target. The menu is prepared with your current target and does not update itself: if the figure changes later, the meal split and the assistant warn you so you can adapt it or generate another one. With the usual diet there is no figure to export; the screen invites you to set a daily target.

Your data

- **Body-fat %:** the current estimate, its date and method, the full composition curve and re-measurement. The estimator offers three methods: **Navy tape** (tape measure at neck and waist, plus hips for women; the most precise), **Gallery** (reference silhouettes) and **Manual** (bioimpedance scale, DEXA or skinfolds). It is a guide with a margin of several points, not a clinical measurement. Always repeat the same method under the same conditions; the app asks you to re-measure every so often.
- **Experience:** editable with one tap.
- **Height:** as declared in the assistant.
- **Your work:** seated, on your feet or physical. It refines what you burn in daily life, beyond steps and workouts (Your estimated burn).
- **Daily step limit:** the daily total the weekly review will never ask you to walk beyond. It applies from the next review.
- **Fat / lean mass split:** with two measurements far enough apart, the split sheet says how much of the weight change was fat and how much lean mass (which includes water and glycogen), the margin of the reading and the kilos of change that would make it reliable. With three or more measurements it adds the split of the whole phase. If the split is going badly and the reading is reliable, it proposes lowering the pace with one tap. The split never modifies your training.
- The first days of a phase, and the first kilos that come back after a cut, are read as neither fat nor muscle: they are mostly water and glycogen, and the app treats them as such instead of writing them into the curve. That is why starting a block no longer produces a step in the body-fat curve, and going back to maintenance after a cut is not presented as lean mass gained.

Phase settings

- **Menstrual cycle mode (optional)** (if your profile is female): reduces the effect of cycle-related weight swings. It works from day one with a standard length; once you mark day 1 twice (first day of bleeding; you can mark a past date) it uses your real length. The mark is optional.
- **Weekly review reminder:** notification that there is a new review to look at. Off by default.
- **Pause phase:** for trips or illness. The loop freezes and those days do not count; adjustments, refeeds and volume protection are kept. On resuming, the app lets a few days pass and asks for several weigh-ins before assessing again. Pausing is better than quitting.
- **Turn the layer off:** switches the module off without deleting anything. The diet phase becomes manual again and body weight can be edited in Settings again.
- **Delete nutrition data:** phase, weigh-ins, library and profile, with double confirmation. Workouts are untouched. The module is included in the app's general backup.

The season planner

Opens from the Season card. You chain Bulk, Maintenance and Cut blocks, each with dates and a weekly pace, and the chart shows the projected weight, lean mass and body-fat % at the end. No need to plan the whole year: the next phase is enough. When a block ends, the app moves to the next one by itself and tells you. Without a plan, the module stays at maintenance: it tracks your weight but proposes neither raising nor lowering calories. If you follow a calorie target and change the pace of the current block, before saving you see what your daily target will become; cancelling saves nothing. On the day the plan changes stage, the tab announces it with your new target and where it starts from, without carrying over the previous stage’s deficit or surplus; if your target was customized, the customization is kept and from there you can remove it (**Remove customization**) or review the target (**Review target**).

Your foods

The library exists so the recommendation reads "cut 60 g of dry rice" rather than "200 kcal less". Six to eight foods you eat daily are enough. For each you enter the name, kcal per 100 g from its label, whether you weigh it dry or cooked, its dominant macronutrient and the minimum adjustment in grams. The most common mistake is the weighing mode: 100 g of dry rice is about 300 g cooked. Without foods, the app uses a list of basics.

Coordination with training

- The diet phase is set by the current block, and the progression engine uses it as always.
- **Performance monitor:** the app tracks two or three main lifts. Selection is automatic; you can change it from its screen. If you change routine, it recalibrates over a few sessions.
- **Distance to the alarm:** the monitor screen opens with a traffic light saying how far the loop is from stepping in (green, amber or red), a gauge of the aggregate drop against the threshold and one row per monitored lift with its change over the window. Below it, how many monitored lifts are falling and how many consecutive evaluations with a drop you have had. In the management index, the row icon already carries the colour of the band. The monitor only arms the alarm in a deficit; outside a deficit the card says so instead of measuring anything. Looking at the traffic light changes nothing: it is a read-only preview.
- **Protecting the stimulus:** if performance in those lifts drops steadily and the diet adjustment does not fix it, the app reduces the volume of your exercises: a little first and, if the drop is confirmed, by 20 %. It never goes below one set per exercise and does not cut indefinitely. Load can keep progressing.
- Refeed and deload go together.
- The weekly review reminds you of an approximate daily protein amount.

Notifications

The module only adds the **Weekly review reminder** (Phase settings), which invites you to come and see how you are doing and your review for the week. The weigh-in reminder is part of the **Daily log reminder** in Settings, which also carries, on the day it is due, the request to re-estimate your body-fat %. Inside the app you will also see a re-measurement reminder that does not nag.

While the phase is calibrating there is no review to show, so the notice does not sound: its first appointment is moved on to the first week in which there can already be a recommendation.

Get the most out of it

- Weigh yourself daily and always the same way.
- Give calibration time.
- One adjustment at a time, for the whole week.
- Choose the way of following the plan that you will really keep up, and if a change does not suit you, tell the weekly review.
- Enter your real foods.
- Update your body-fat % with the same method.
- If you travel, pause the phase.
- The PRO trial lasts 16 training sessions and calibration needs its time: the loop’s value shows with more mileage.

17. Support tools

Plate calculator

It opens from Routine → Details → Equipment available, through its shortcut; it is no longer in the top bar. Three blocks:

- **Barbell:** target weight and bar weight; it tells you which plates to put on each side using only the ones you have configured. If the target cannot be made exactly, it warns you.
- **Machine or cable** where plates load on one side only: target load and breakdown.
- **Warm-up sets:** enter your 1RM for a main exercise and the app proposes five sets (three essential and two optional), raising the weight and lowering the reps.

During a session you do not need to open it: the plates button in the set panel gives you the breakdown and the warm-up ramp for the load in front of you, already filled in (section 7).

Rest timer

Described in section 4 (During the session): countdown with alarm and minute beeps, notification with the next set, floating timer on Android, Live Activity on iPhone and smartwatch notice.

18. Sharing your training

- **Share session:** from the history, an image with the date, tonnage, total reps and exercise details, with the TrueLift branding. With **Background photo** you put one of your own gallery photos behind it —from the gym, from the session or whatever you like— instead of the app background; it gets a dark veil so the figures on top stay readable. Before sharing you can change or remove it, and it is only used for that image: it is not saved in your history.
- **Body evolution** (PRO): from the photo comparator, an image with your two photos —side by side, as a curtain or overlaid, just as you are viewing them— and the numbers that explain them: days elapsed, weight and girths.
- **Monthly report** (PRO): from Progress, as HTML, to share or archive.

19. Backup and TrueLift Coach

Your data lives on your phone. In **Settings → Backup**:

- **Export backup:** saves routine, history, settings and nutrition data to a file. Keep it somewhere safe.
- **Restore:** loads a backup on another phone or after reinstalling. It replaces all current data with the backup's.
- The app offers you a backup by itself at the moments when you could lose something: before importing a routine or a history, and in the last sessions of the PRO trial.

The same backup lets you show your training to a coach and open it in **TrueLift Coach** (truelift.es/coach/), the desktop app for reviewing your metrics and editing your routines on a computer. The link is on the TrueLift PRO screen and at the end of the monthly report.

Bringing your history from Hevy or Strong

If you are coming from Hevy or Strong you can bring across what you already trained, and it is free. Export your data from that app —both produce a file from their own settings— and load it into TrueLift from Routine → Routine tools → Import from Hevy or Import from Strong.

Both imports come in under the same conditions: what fits TrueLift's library is imported and what does not is discarded; at the end, the app says how many sessions came in and why the rest stayed out. Only sessions earlier than your first own entry come in, so nothing you already had in TrueLift is touched, and loading the same file again duplicates nothing. The imported history counts towards your charts, your real volume and your personal records.

20. Recommendations by level

If you are starting

- Choose Simple linear progression.
- Prioritise technique and log RIR honestly.
- Set up your equipment, log your sessions and let the app guide you.

If you are experienced

- When linear progression stalls, move to Double progression.
- Consider Top set + back-offs on the big basics.
- Turn on autoregulation and log your daily readiness, session effort and cardio.
- If you combine strength and endurance, log all your cardio with realistic duration and intensity.
- Use drop sets sparingly and on isolation exercises or machines: one or two at the end of the session, not on every exercise.
- Supersets are for saving time, not for training harder: pair exercises that do not compete with each other and keep the heavy compound lifts out of them.
- Use rest-pause like the drop set: on isolation exercises or machines and in moderation. It gets a lot of work done in little time; it is not meant for every exercise.
- Mark the exercise as trained with pain as soon as something hurts. Training lightly without breaking your progression beats skipping the exercise or forcing it.
- Take a photo and some measurements today: three months from now they are the ones you will value most.
- If you wear a watch, connect it: resting HR, HRV, sleep, steps and your runs come in by themselves and stop being a daily chore.
- When you are unsure how an exercise is performed, open its technique video before the first set, not after it.
- If you want to weigh what you eat, follow a calorie target, start with the meal split and let the scale and the weekly review do the correcting. The AI menu is a starting point, not a prescription.

21. Frequently asked questions

Do I lose my data when the PRO trial ends? No. Routine and history are kept; only PRO features are locked. If you used a custom routine, make a backup before it expires: the app offers it.

Is the PRO version a subscription? Your choice: monthly subscription, one year or a one-time lifetime payment. All through Google Play or the App Store, restorable on any phone with your account.

I can't change sets, RIR or add exercises. Editing the routine is a PRO feature. In the free version you can swap an exercise for another of the same pattern and group.

I can't load the proposed weight. Check **Routine → Details → Equipment available**: 1.25 kg plates, microloading and dumbbell jump.

I loaded a different weight and the app proposes mine, not its own. On purpose: if you changed it by hand and did not progress, it keeps yours. When you progress, the new weight is built from your equipment.

"prev." shows one session, but the proposal comes from another. That last session does not drive progression (deload, amber or red day, or reduced intensity). The card explains it and says which session it starts from.

Why won't it let me save a second session today? Only one strength session per calendar day is saved. Edit today's to add what is missing. If you train at night and log after midnight, you take up the next day.

What are the small bars under the exercise? Progression attempts: each is an attempt to hit the target with the current weight. When they run out, the app warns of the decisive attempt, tries reordering (PRO) and, if you stay stuck, proposes a step back.

I've been weeks without training. Between 2 and 8 weeks, the app lets you choose a modulated return or picking up where you left off. After more than 8, it rebuilds your level in a few sessions with manual weights.

Why is this increase smaller than other times? Because the last session was very demanding, you are in a deficit or you did not log RIR. That is the expected behaviour.

My leg hurts, does everything stop? No. With autoregulation, set the zone in the check-in and the app slows only the exercises of that region.

I slept badly and my HRV came out low. A single night modulates nothing. Only the sustained signal counts.

How do I enter the assisted pull-up? The assistance as a positive number, as the machine shows it. Progressing means removing assistance; at 0, move to the regular pull-up.

Can I switch from kg to lb without breaking the history? Yes. Only what you see changes.

Why doesn't this month's report appear? Reports exist only for closed months, and they are a PRO feature.

My overall level doesn't appear. It needs at least three exercises with a record from two different patterns; the card says how many are missing. If you do not declare sex and date of birth, the thresholds for a 25–40-year-old man are used.

Do I have to count calories? No. If you choose to adjust your usual diet, the nutrition layer only needs your daily weight and changes are relative to what you already eat. If you prefer a figure, choose to follow a calorie target.

I've been weighing myself for two weeks and it proposes nothing. That is calibration: until your weight trend is reliable there are no proposals. The weekly review shows Waiting for data and, once it is known, the estimated date of the first review.

Today I weigh a kilo more than yesterday. It is water, salt, glycogen or gut content. The app looks at the trend, not the spike.

Why can't I change my body weight or the phase in Settings? With the nutrition layer on, weight is driven by your weigh-ins and the phase by the current block of the plan. When you turn the layer off, both become manual again.

The app has cut my sets. Your performance in the monitored lifts was dropping steadily and the diet adjustment did not fix it. It is temporary, has a floor and load can keep progressing. The weekly review explains it.

What happens to my nutrition data if I turn the module off or PRO expires? It is kept and comes back when you reactivate it.

The floating timer doesn't appear. Check that you are on Android, that the countdown is on and that you granted the Display over other apps permission. Inside TrueLift the capsule hides on purpose. The setting's «?» explains which permissions are needed and what to check if it does not show with the phone locked.

Can I get the rest-finished notice on my watch? Yes: allow TrueLift notifications on your smartwatch. You can keep only the "Rest finished" channel.

Can I use a drop set and top set + back-offs on the same exercise? No. Each exercise uses a single mode and turning one on turns the other off: they distribute the load across the sets in different ways.

Why can I not put an exercise with a drop set, rest-pause or top + back-offs into a superset? Because a superset is trained with straight sets: you alternate sets with another exercise, and that cannot be done while chaining weight drops or short pauses with no rest. Remove that mode and the switch becomes available; the note underneath says which exercise is using it.

My drops do not appear in records or in performance. That is on purpose. They are done to failure and without rest, so their mark measures the fatigue of the moment, not your form. They count towards volume and tonnage, and the exercise is evaluated by its first set.

My shoulder hurt today and I lowered the weight. Does that ruin my progression? No, as long as you mark the exercise as trained with pain; the app offers it by itself when you lower the load. That session is not scored, does not use up an attempt and does not lower your reference.

Where do I see which plates to load? In the set itself: the plates button in the panel opens the breakdown of that load and its warm-up sets. The full calculator is in Routine → Details → Equipment available.

Are my progress photos uploaded anywhere? No. They are stored in the app's private storage on your phone, outside your gallery, and they never leave it. To move them to another phone, export them as a ZIP from Settings → Backup.

My routine takes longer than a week and the volume does not add up. Set the Microcycle in Volume (Routine → Volume) to the real number of days of one full pass: the weekly figures are recalculated with that length.

Can TrueLift read my watch? Yes, with PRO: Settings → Autoregulation and HRV → Read data from Health Connect (on iPhone, from Apple Health). It reads your resting HR, night HRV, sleep, steps, calories, weight and cardio workouts. Read-only, nothing leaves the phone, and it is in BETA. The Health Connect / Apple Health row in Settings explains what is read and why.

I opened the app and today's data is not there. TrueLift reads the health platform, not the watch: if your watch app has not pushed the day there yet, there is nothing to read. Every time you open the app the last few days are gone over again, so data that arrives late ends up coming in by itself.

My watch does not measure HRV, or I do not want to grant that permission. That is fine: HRV is still entered by hand in the check-in and the rest of the data comes in as usual. Whatever you do not grant is simply not read.

I changed watch and my HRV looks different. It is: every brand measures it its own way. The app notices and starts a new band from the new watch's nights; your history is kept and the chart does not cross that boundary.

My runs show up in the history by themselves. That is the connected watch: aerobic workouts come in as cardio with their real duration and an intensity estimated from your heart rate. If you do not want them, delete that session —it will not come back— or turn the connected watch off.

Where is the Volume tab? It is no longer a tab: volume and frequency open with the two buttons in the Routine tab, under the Details drop-down. The numbers are the same.

Where do I set up my plates and micro-loads? In the Routine tab, in Details → Equipment available. The deload week is next to it, in the Routine tools. Both used to live in Settings.

I imported a routine and my weights are unchanged, is that right? Yes. If the imported routine keeps the split, the progression system and the number of sessions, the weights the app was already proposing are kept. They only start over when one of those three changes, and the dialogue tells you before importing.

I am coming from Hevy or Strong, can I bring my history? Yes, and it is free: Routine → Routine tools → Import from Hevy or Import from Strong, with the file each app exports. See section 19.

How do I know whether I am doing an exercise properly? Library exercises that have a video carry a TECHNIQUE button, both in the routine and during the session. It opens inside the app and returns you to the set you were on.

On assisted dips the app kept proposing more weight. Log that exercise as Assisted dip machine, not as Chest dip machine: the first is the counterweight machine —you type the assistance and progressing means taking it away— and the second the plate-loaded one you sit at and push.

Why can I not go back to Cardio with a session under way? On purpose: while you train, the Strength/Cardio selector is hidden and side-swiping is blocked so you do not end up in Cardio by accident with no way back. Save or discard the session and the selector returns.

Can I tell how much rest is left without looking at my phone? Yes: turn on **minute beeps** in Settings → During the session. Every full minute you hear one beep per minute left, and the alarm marks the end. With the phone locked, the notification —or the Live Activity on iPhone— also tells you the exercise and set that come next.

Can I share my workout with one of my own photos? Yes. In the history, tap Share on the session and choose **Background photo**: the image comes out with your photo behind and the session data on top.

Does TrueLift write my diet? No. If you follow a calorie target, it gives you your daily target and its split into macros and meals (Nutrition → Your current plan → Meal plan and menu). If you want an actual menu, **Create your weekly menu with AI** prepares a prompt with your figures and preferences for you to paste into your AI; the menu you get back is indicative and TrueLift does not verify it.

I don’t want to eat what the app recommends. Tap **Customize** on Your current plan —or the pencil next to the kcal in the meal split— and type your figure: macros and meals are recalculated, reviews keep your difference and **Back to recommended** undoes it. The weekly review keeps watching your scale.

The weekly review asks me to walk too much. Set your daily step limit in Nutrition → Your data, or with the Change step limit link on the card itself. From the next review on, the walking route will not ask you to go beyond that total.

What is the difference between a drop set and rest-pause? In a drop set you lower the weight without resting; in rest-pause you keep the same weight and rest a few seconds between short sets. Both are PRO, both go to failure and in both only the first set counts towards your performance and records.

I changed machine and that exercise's performance no longer makes sense. Expand the exercise in the Routine tab and tap **Reset performance baseline**: it stops being compared with earlier sessions and the app builds a new baseline. Your history and records are left untouched.

I changed routine: have I lost my sessions? No. The history and the calendar show everything you have trained, and sessions from previous routines carry a strip saying so. You can share and delete them, but not edit them.

I made a mistake logging a cardio session. Tap the pencil on that cardio card in the history and correct it; there is no need to delete it.

My knee is bothering me and today is an upper-body day: will it hold me back? No. With autoregulation, localised discomfort only limits the body region it belongs to: the header chip shows each region separately and your upper-body exercises carry on, with their increases and records.

On my Xiaomi, the app says Health Connect is not responding. The system is blocking the connection. Allow Health Connect and TrueLift to start automatically in the phone's settings and open the app again. In the meantime, you can keep entering data by hand.

Where do I note the seat height or grip for a machine? In the exercise's Notes and settings, in the **Pinned exercise log**: it is kept across every session.

Where is the plate calculator? It is no longer in the top bar: it opens from Routine → Details → Equipment available, and every set has its own plates button with the load already filled in.

Can I create an exercise measured by time? Yes, with PRO: when you create it, choose Time under Progresses by. You log seconds and it progresses like the plank.

Which of the two ways of following the plan suits me? If you eat similarly almost every day and do not want to count calories, adjust your usual diet. If your eating varies from day to day or you want more precision, follow a calorie target. You can switch whenever you like from Nutrition → How you follow your plan.

I ticked an option in the weekly review; has my target changed already? No. Until you tap Apply, what you see is a preview; Postpone does not change anything either.

I couldn’t keep up last week’s change. Tell the weekly review when it asks (Partly or Barely): that week no other change is added on top and you keep the one you already had.

I generated an AI menu and now my target is different. The menu does not update itself: the meal split and the menu assistant warn you so you can adapt it or generate a new one with the current figure.

My leg press already weighs something without plates; how do I enter it? In the set’s plate breakdown, under Starting fixed weight, choose Fixed weight and type what the machine weighs. You keep logging only the plates; the app counts that weight for your increases, your records and your tonnage.

Can I turn off the record and level banners? Yes: Settings → During the session → Record and level alerts. When you save the session, the summary still mentions them.

Why does my drop set ask for a number of reps rather than a range? Because only the first set decides progression and its target is a specific number, also in double progression.

On my iPhone, does the rest sound with silent mode on? Yes. During the rest, the beeps and the alarm go through the audio channel, also with the phone locked, with silent mode on or with TrueLift notifications turned off.

I've turned off TrueLift notifications on my phone. The app works just the same. Switches that promise a reminder show an amber line saying so —on iPhone, with a button to open the settings— and when you allow them again, the reminders come back on their own.

22. About the author

TrueLift was created by Rubén Soro. His approach: evidence-based training, with no shortcuts, to progress with sound judgement in every session.

Author's website: www.rubensoro.es

App website: www.truelift.es

TrueLift — Train with sound judgement.